

The Federal Polytechnic, Mubi

School of Creative Art Technology

Language and Communication Department

COURSE: COMMUNICATION IN ENGLISH IV

COURSE CODE: GNS 401

By

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GENERAL OBJECTIVES:

1.0: Comprehend the theory and practice of communication Communication

- the process by which people exchange information or express their thoughts and feelings.
- Process by which information is exchanged between individuals through a common system of symbols, signs, or behavior.
- Communication - the evolving of a shared or common meaning in another person
- Interpersonal Communication - communication between two or more people in an organization
- Communicator - the person originating the message.
- Behavioral Characteristics of Competent Communicators
 - i. Immediacy – psychological closeness
 - ii. Supportiveness – empathy, sense of personal control
 - iii. Strategic ambiguity – purposeful use of symbols to allow multiple interpretations.
 - iv. Interaction management – patterns of interaction to move among topics.

Elements of the Communication Process

Elements in the communication cycle include:

- | | | |
|--------------|-------------|--------------------|
| i. Sender | iv. Channel | vii. Feedback |
| ii. Encode | v. Receiver | viii. Response and |
| iii. Message | vi. Decode | ix. Noise |

Types Of Communication (Verbal – Non-Verbal)

Verbal Communication.

- i. Spoken rather than written
- ii. Relating to words or using words
- iii. Relating to a verb

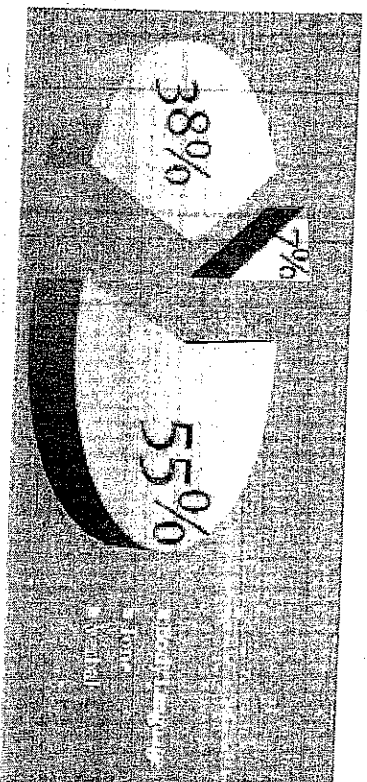
Non-verbal Communication

Nonverbal Communication - all elements of communication that do not involve words.

When you are trying to understand a communication, *words are only part of the story*. To analyse it properly *you need to see and feel what is being said as well*. Only 7% of meaning is in the words spoken.

38% of meaning is paralinguistic (the way that the words are said). 55% is in facial expression.
(source: Albert Mehrabian)

Non-Verbal Communication



Main categories Non-Verbal Communication

- i. Kinesics (Facial expressions)
- ii. Eye contact
- iii. Interpersonal distance
- iv. Touch
- v. Body orientation and posture
- vi. Hand and other gestures
- vii. Your appearance

Kinesics (Facial Expressions)

These usually convey emotions. There are 6 Universal emotions

- i. Surprise
- ii. Fear
- iii. Sadness
- iv. Anger
- v. Happiness
- vi. Disgust

Kinesics is the study of how we use facial expressions, gestures, postures, and eye behavior.

There are 5 categories:

- Emblems are direct replacements for words allowing shorthand communication for simple ideas.

- Illustrators-small movements and postures used to emphasize or punctuate ideas.
- Affect Displays-Facial expressions sometimes supported by posture.
- Regulators-eye movements, head nods, postures that regulate conversation.
- Adaptors-Actions that release physical or emotional tension when someone is anxious.

Eye contact

Eye contact movements that add cues for the receiver

- Eye contact shows interest/attraction
- Look more frequently when we're interested.
- Staring can be un-nerving.

Paralanguage.

Paralanguage - variations in speech, such as:

- Pitch
- Stress
- Timing
- Pauses
- Emotional tone of voice
- Accent
- Speech errors (um, err)
- Speed of speech
- Interruptions
- Fast speech often indicates anxiety.
- Slow speech is often assumed to mean low levels of intelligence.
- Interruptions are usually natural, but can be forced (butting in) and there is gender differences.

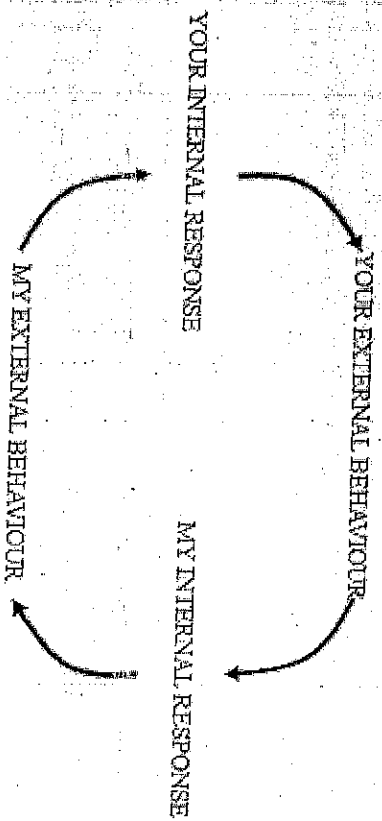


Communication Theory

- “Communication is the process by which information is transmitted and received”.
- ‘Process’ is a means to an end.
- ‘Information’ includes factual + other + NVC.
- ‘Received’ crucial verb as transmitting is only half the story.
- “The meaning of the communication is the response that you get”.



Communication Is Cyclical.



Human Expressiveness

- Body language 55%
- Voice tonality 38%
- Words 7%

Five Styles of Listening

- Ignoring
- Pretending to listen
- Selective listening
- Attentive — reflective listening

- Empathic listening – with

intention to really understand.

Listening Is a Three-Stage Process

- You hear what is said – *all Vs & NVCs*
- You understand what you heard – *reflect, paraphrase summarise check understanding.*
- You interpret what you understood – you are then ready to respond.

Communication Barriers

factors that block or significantly distort successful communication.

- i. Physical separation
- ii. Status differences
- iii. Gender differences
- iv. Cultural diversity
- v. Language

Barriers to effective communication:

- Within the doctor
- Within the patient
- Within the environment

Barriers to Communication: Listener (Doctor)

- Mental state
- Poor listener – easily distracted.
- Negative previous experience
- Pursuing own agenda
- Over-controlling
- Personal prejudices

Barriers to Communication: Speaker (Patient)

- Hidden agenda
- Lack of motivation
- Easily distracted.
- Personal prejudices Negative previous experience
- Mental state

Barriers to Communication: Environment

- External noise and interruptions
- Time factors – late busy, time constrained.

Patient Agenda

- Beliefs
- Hopes and fears.

- Hidden problems
- Expectations
- Presenting problems
- Secondary problems, perceived problems, and perceived effects

Doctor Agenda

- Information gathering and fact collecting.
- Analysing, further questioning clarifying
- Interpreting and verifying
- Sharing understanding

2.0 KNOW THE CONCEPT OF ORGANISATIONAL COMMUNICATION.

Organizational Communication

the ways in which groups of people maintain structure and order through their symbolic interactions and allow individual actors the freedom to accomplish their goals.

Structuration Communication

The process of forming and maintaining structures through verbal and nonverbal communication, which establishes norms and rules governing members' behaviors.

Reasons for Organizational Communication

- So you can ask informed questions about everyday business practices
- To develop communication skills that improve your ability to succeed in the workplace.
- To improve the quality of your work life

Types of Organizations Communication

- Economic Orientation – products/services
- Political Orientation – generate and distribute power and control
- Integration Orientation – mediate and resolve discord
- Pattern Maintenance Orientation – promote cultural and educational regularity

Central Features of Organizations Communication

Types of Organizational Structures

- i. Traditional bureaucratic structures
 - a. Division of labor – how work is divided
 - b. Chain of command – lines of authority
 - c. Downward communication – superiors initiate messages to subordinates
- ii. Participatory structures
 - a. Value individuals' goals needs and feelings while pursuing organizational objectives
 - b. Encourage participation of members
 - Quality circles
 - Autonomous work groups
 - Alternative work groups

Organizational Assimilation

- i. Organizational culture
- ii. Formal sources of information
- iii. Informal sources of information

Conflict Management Skills

- Avoidance – deny the existence of conflict
- Competition – conflict is seen as a battle with a winner and a loser
- Compromise – willingness to negotiate and lose some of your position if the other party is willing to do the same
- Accommodation – set aside your views in favor of the other's
- Collaboration – thoughtful negotiation and reasoned compromise

The Dark Side of Workplace Communication

- Aggressive Communication
- Verbal aggressiveness
- Workplace aggression

- Workplace violence
- Sexual Harassment
- Unwelcome, unsolicited, repeated behavior of a sexual nature
- Quid-pro-quo – this for that
- Hostile work environment – workplace conditions that are sexually offensive, intimidating, or hostile.

Communication Networks

- i. Formal communication networks – follow prescribed channels of communication.
- ii. Informal communication networks – emerges from the natural social interaction among organization members.

Formal Communication Networks

- ➡ Flows along official paths prescribed by organization's chain of command and shown by organizational chart
- ➡ Formal messages flow:
 - i. Downward (Traditional Organization flow)
 - ii. Upward
 - iii. Horizontally

Downward Communication

- ➡ Formal messages that flow from managers and supervisors down to subordinates
- ➡ Downward communication adds to employee satisfaction.
 - ➡ Can lead to information overload.
 - ➡ Employees with information overload not necessarily dissatisfied with their jobs.
 - ➡ All employees who experienced information underload were dissatisfied
- ➡ A problem with downward communication is that it is often in written form
 - ➡ There are several problems with written messages:

- ➡ They are usually brief and may omit needed details.
- ➡ Because of need for brevity, memos normally do not include the job rationale.

- ➡ Frame of reference differences make interpretation of messages difficult.

Upward Communication

- ➡ Formal messages that flow upward from subordinates to supervisors and managers
 - ➡ The following types of messages are valuable when upwardly communicated:
 - ➡ Reports of employee work, achievements, progress
 - ➡ Outlines of work problems that need to be solved
 - ➡ Suggestions for improvements within department or company
 - ➡ How employees think and feel about their jobs, associates, company

Horizontal Communication

- ➡ Messages that flow laterally between people of same rank
 - ➡ Important for coordinating tasks, solving problems, sharing information, resolving conflicts
 - ➡ Especially valuable for difficult or complex problems
 - ➡ Empowered teams
 - ➡ Teams with power to make decisions

Informal Communication Networks

- ➡ Messages that flow along informal network
 - ➡ Grapevine
 - ➡ Exists because of limited formal networks
 - ➡ Many view grapevine as unimportant, but research indicates the opposite
 - ➡ Type of information grapevine carries indicates health of organization
 - ➡ Information carried by grapevine is 75-95% accurate
 - ➡ Information carried by grapevine travels fast

- People who regularly use grapevine are more satisfied with their jobs and more committed to organization
- Effective managers use grapevine
- Two advantages to using informal communication networks
 - Can get advice and information without formally having to admit we need it
 - We can "think out loud" about problems, increasing self-confidence and problem-solving ability.
 - Stimulates innovative thinking.

Interpersonal Communication and Intrapersonal Communication

Interpersonal Communication

Interpersonal communication is communication where exchange of ideas and information happens between two or more people by way of any channel. This can be face to face, online, over the phone, or in written forms as well.

There are several aspects that make this type of communication explicitly interpersonal:

- **Inescapable:** Even when we hold some thought inside us and do not let it out verbally, it will take its form in other nonverbal aspects of communication such as mood, attitude, or body language.
- **Irreversible:** Once something is written, said, or submitted, it cannot be taken back. It is forever in the minds of others.
- **Complex:** There is a high chance of miscommunication between sender and receiver, therefore interpersonal communication is complex.
- **Contextual:** Context is an integral part of this type of communication, and the context can be situational, environmental, and relational.

Intrapersonal Communication

Intrapersonal communication is the communication done with oneself. Included are the thoughts, assessments, contemplations, and feelings that are associated with one's inner communication.

Here are some things that are uniquely intrapersonal:

- **Self-Concept:** One's own self concept is at the center of intrapersonal communication. It includes an evaluation of one's own beliefs, values, and attitudes, and how that evaluation plays into what occurs in the outer world.
- **Perception:** Perception is how people interpret what is going on around them. Perception can influence intrapersonal communication.
- **Expectations:** Expectations are based upon intrapersonal communication with one's own self, and are predictions of what will happen based on perceptions of what has happened.

Debate, Conference, meeting, and seminar

Debate

A debate is basically an argument. That is not an undisciplined shouting match between parties that passionately believe in a particular point of view. In fact, the opposite is true. Debating has strict rules of conduct and quite sophisticated arguing techniques and you will often be in a position where you will have to argue the opposite of what you believe in.

The Definition

If a debate is going to take place, then it must be agreed in advance what the debate is going to be about. Deciding and explaining what a topic means is called 'defining the topic'. The job of defining begins with the AFFIRMATIVE. The first speaker of the affirmative must explain in clear terms what they believe the topic means. In deciding this the affirmative team should always try to use the "person on the street" test.

The negative team may agree with or choose to challenge the definition presented. The negative team should be very careful about challenging themselves as it is difficult to continue the debate with two definitions.

The 3 major parts of a debate

- i. Constructive speech
- ii. Cross examination
- iii. Rebuttal

Constructive Speech

- i. Begins with BIRT (Be it resolved that...)
- ii. States 3 or 4 supporting points first

- iii. Then elaborates on each one.
- iv. Plan your strategy (for e.g., go from strongest to weakest)
- v. Recap at the end

Cross-Examination

- Most difficult part
- Thinking on your feet
- Question the validity of your opponents' constructive speech by source, date, relevance
- Show their weakest points.
- Question them aggressively.
- Start with general questions then get really specific
- Undermine the evidence.

Rebuttal

- Designed to argue the case made.
- It's your time to point out the inconsistencies, absurdities, and illogical arguments of your opponents.
- Provides the opportunity for speakers to critique their opponents' arguments.
- Absolutely no new evidence may be presented during this time.
- It's time to do some final damage here.

Resolution

- The topic of the debate
- The point on which both parties have agreed to debate.
- Always stated in the positive
- Begins with the phrase (BIRT):

Be it resolved that ...

The Individual Speaker

There are many techniques that each speaker can use in their speech but there are three main areas that you will be marked on and they are matter, method, and manner.

Method of Debate

Where matter is what you say method is how you organize what you say. There are many pieces of the method:

1. TEAM.

A good team method involves unity and logic. Unity is created by all members being aware of the definition, what the other speakers have said and what the team line is.

2. INDIVIDUAL.

You must structure your own speech well. The first step is to have a clear idea of your own arguments and which examples you will be using to support those arguments.

When you are presenting one argument make sure that the argument is logical and that you make clear links between your team line and the argument.

Rebuttal should be organized the same way. Attack each argument that the opposition presents in turn. Spend a little while on each and then move on to the next.

Also organize your speech well in terms of time. Adjudicators can pick up when you are waiting just to fill in time ...

Meeting

The Seven Meeting Step

Meeting Process is a methodology for improving the efficiency and effectiveness of meetings. The meeting process adheres to the following timed agenda:

- i. Clarify Aim/Purpose
- ii. Assign Roles
- iii. Review Agenda
- iv. Work through Agenda
- v. Review meeting record
- vi. Plan Next Steps and Next Agenda

vii. Evaluate.

- i. **Clarify Aim/Purpose** – It is very important, at the beginning of the meeting, to clarify and agree the purpose of the meeting. This promotes focus and clarity in the event of conversation drift, or if members feel lost in the process.
- ii. **Assign Roles** – There are 4 roles to be assigned:
 - a. **Leader** – The team leader role is not intended to be a power position, but rather a functional one. The leader can be the person who called the meeting or can ask for a volunteer to lead the meeting.
 - b. **Recorder** – The recorder's role is crucial to ensure that key ideas, themes and actions are recorded for all to see. Recording on flip charts around the meeting room is encouraged.
 - c. **Timekeeper** – The timekeeper keeps everyone on track with agreed timings for each agenda item, whilst also making appropriate contributions to any discussion. Once timings have been agreed for each agenda item, the time keeper should follow a rule of 50%. If an agenda item has been allocated 10 minutes
 - d. **Facilitator** – As much as possible the group should identify someone with accomplished facilitation skills for this role. The role of facilitator can be challenging and may not be required for every group situation.
- iii. **Review Agenda and Times** – This should be a quick review of proposed agenda items and clarification of late agenda submissions.
- iv. **Work through Agenda** – The majority of the meeting should be devoted to working through agenda items. Steps 1 -3 and 5 -7 should take no longer than 5 minutes each, enabling an efficient, productive discussion focused on the agenda items.
- v. **Review meeting record** – When the agenda items have been discussed, the leader should take the opportunity to quickly review what has been accomplished, the key actions and responsibility for follow-up.

vi. **Plan Next Steps and Next Agenda** – Based on what has been accomplished, the leader should ask the group to determine what the agenda items should be for the next meeting.

vii. **Evaluate** – This final step supports the group to stay on track and improve future meetings. There are 3 steps to evaluation. Each group member should allocate a score ranging from 0 (worst meeting ever) to 10 (effective and efficient meeting where expectations were surpassed, and progress was made).

Conference

How to Run an Effective Conference: The 7 Steps You Need to Follow

To promote your event and encourage engagement, prioritize social media.

1. Work out the key details in advance..

It's important to set yourself up for success. So, while the temptation might be to gloss over the finer details of running a conference, you have to take the time to think ahead about how it's all going to come together -- or your event could end up a disaster. Start by considering:

- What are your goals for your event? What do you hope to achieve?
- Who is this event for? Why will these people attend?
- When and where will the event take place? What should a ticket cost?
- How much will the event cost? What is your budget?
- Who is going to speak at your event? How will the schedule be organized?

2. Determine what your value proposition is.

As with any product or service, you must be clear on what your guests will walk away with after attending your conference. And, depending on who your target audience is, that's going to vary.

Common elements to consider here include networking opportunities, tips and advice shared from the stage or in work sessions -- even the entertainment offered. MicroConf is a great example of a conference that created two versions of the event, geared toward two different entrepreneurial levels and two different regions of the world.

3. Choose the perfect venue.

Your venue can make or break the event. That may at first seem like an overstatement, until you consider all relevant factors. A great venue should offer a "hallway" area in which attendees can network during the breaks, as well as be a relatively private area for the event.

Convene is a great example of a venue designed for exactly this purpose, and the venue's professional staff can help you build the small details into your conference day that will make a difference (hint: Food and snacks matter more than might you think).

4. Decide the best time to hold your event.

Give yourself plenty of time to plan for your event. If you have too tight of a deadline, many things could fall through the cracks. Additionally, you'll want to do some research and uncover any competing events occurring. Another benefit of deciding your event in advance is giving your potential audience plenty of notice.

5. Set your budget.

Taking all considerations into account, how much will your event cost? Assess the pertinent areas, including the venue, speakers, entertainers, catering, staffing and the like. Tools like Demand Metric's conference budget template can be really helpful in laying out exactly what the event is going to cost.

Many organizations put on events that initially don't net revenue at all in the short term, but do result in long-term sales because of the awareness, authority and credibility built through the audience targeted. Just be sure you decide what you are hoping to gain from your event.

6. Choose your speakers carefully.

Depending on the size and nature of your event, you can also put the call out for speakers and have them apply to win a spot on your roster. Just keep in mind that ticket sales could hinge on who will be coming to share, which means your list should be at least partially curated.

7. Find attendees on Facebook.

Marketing will play a critical role in the success of your event. When it comes to promoting your event and encouraging engagement, be sure to prioritize social media.

Seminar

Starting your seminar plan as early as possible

Once you've got the green light on your seminar (at the very minimum, four to six months before your event), it's time to start the tasks below. The sooner you can check these tasks off your planning list, the better!

1. Establish your goals and objectives

First, write down your seminar's purpose. Then, set goals for how many people you want to attend in person or to watch your live stream. Finally, set a clear profit goal, which will help you calculate how much to charge attendees.

2. Put together a rough budget

With your profit goal in mind, set your ticket prices. Reflecting on the expenses of past seminars or webinars will help you price your event competitively without sacrificing profit.

3. Select a date

Choose two dates – an optimal and a second-best for backup just in case.

4. Decide on your event format

Determine whether you should host your event online or in person. Depending on your location and target date, COVID-19 restrictions might make large in-person seminars difficult to host.

5. Research speakers, locations, and vendors

Start by identifying speakers who've appeared at similar seminars or webinars. Research each one's previous talks and seminar topics to determine your top picks.

6. Start your sponsor search

Sponsors can help fund your seminar or webinar, letting you do more than you would if you had to fund everything yourself.

7. Finalise speakers

As your event approaches, you'll need to nail down some details, like finalising speaker fees and getting contracts signed.

8. Organise financials

Keep your financial information under control to avoid any budget surprises and stay on track with your spending.

9. Build your seminar website

A website for your seminar can generate buzz and attract attendees.

10. Start promotion

Seminar and webinar best practices require promotion of your event to establish your brand and build your audience.

11. Finalise venue details

Dive into the venue details as your seminar date approaches. For in-person events, you may need to work with your caterer on a menu, taking into account any special dietary needs of attendees.

12. Draft your seminar agenda

Outline your seminar's schedule and decide who'll speak when. Make sure every speaker has enough time to provide their input before you finalise it. Incorporate breaks into the agenda for attendees and speakers.

Two months before: Finalising details

With your seminar or webinar in sight, the days will start flying by. Here's what you need to focus on in the two months leading up to your event.

13. Convince interested event-goers

It's time to start attracting your attendees. Send regular emails over the next three to four weeks to let anyone who's on the fence know that they have a limited time to register.

14. Finalise schedule and scripts

Distribute a schedule to your speakers and participants to ensure your seminar or webinar runs smoothly. Get sign-off on any scripts from speakers so they can finish preparing their remarks.

15. Update your stakeholders

Email your company stakeholders, speakers, and sponsors with final registration numbers so that they know what to expect at the event.

16. Confirm timings of all your vendors

Follow up with your vendors to ensure everyone arrives at the right time. Reach out to your caterer, A/V vendor, decorating company, and speakers and provide a detailed timeline in advance and answer any last-minute questions.